25901249 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSEENG200 - READING MALAYALAM CINEMA

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. When did the first Communist government come to power in Kerala after state reorganisation? [K] / [CO1]

   a). 1954 b). 1956 c). 1957 d). 1960

2. Who plays the role of Shekaran in *Swaroopam*? [K] / [CO1]

   a). Sreenivasan b). Thilakan c). Mammooty d). None of the Above

3. In *Manichitrathazhu*, Madampally Meda primarily signifies: [U] / [CO2]

   a). Symbol of urban progress b). Symbol of family tradition

   c). Site of political reform d). Marker of colonial control

4. The film *Lokah Chapter 1: Chandra* reworks Kerala folklore by: [U] / [CO2]

   a). Retelling it unchanged
   b). Modernizing mythic figures
   c). Rejecting mythology
   d). Documenting ballads

5. In *Lekhayude Maranam Oru Flashback*, what does “double mystification” refer to? [U] / [CO3]

   a). Strict commercial narrative
   b). Complete alienation effect
   c). Pure documentary realism
   d). Blending reality and fiction layers

6. Who wrote the screenplay for *Oru Vadakkan Veeragatha*? [K] / [CO4]

   a). M. T. Vasudevan Nair
   b). Lohithadas
   c). Sreenivasan
   d). Ranjith

7. According to Rashid et al. (2024), what role does film play regarding the transgender community? [An] / [CO4]

   a). It serves only as commercial entertainment
   b). It shapes cultural attitudes toward the community
   c). It records historical transition dates
   d). It replaces legal frameworks for identity

8. The “Urban Body” is described as adaptable because it: [U] / [CO4]

   a). Rejects all forms of modernity
   b). Represents only upper-class characters
   c). Strictly follows traditional gender roles
   d). Reflects changing cultural and social identities of urban men

9. The author suggests that the appeal of *Drishyam* is not an ahistorical return to patriarchy but a response to: [An] / [CO4]

   a). A specific historical context of scrutiny

b). A lack of other films

c). Improved camera technology

d). Falling ticket prices

10. The popularity of the celebrity body is primarily rooted in its ability to: [K] / [CO4]

a). Serve as a mirror that allows audiences to identify with both the hero and their own sense of otherness

b). Reinforce fixed social hierarchies without audience involvement

c). Eliminate the influence of social psychology from cinematic narratives

d). Represent purely individual emotions detached from society

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

11. Describe how Malayalam cinema developed its own distinct character in contrast to other Indian cinemas. [An] / [CO1]

12. Is Nagavally or Sreedevi a foil to Ganga? Substantiate [E] / [CO2]

13. Write a short note on the theme of tragedy in the film *Lekhayude Maranam Oru Flashback.* [U] / [CO3]

14. What does the author mean by "empirical truth" in the context of *Drishyam*? [K] / [CO4]

15. Identify the three theorists mentioned in *Aalorukkam* and the concepts they contributed to the analysis. [K] / [CO4]

16. Narrate the central plot of *Vanaprastham*, focusing on the life and struggles of Kunhikuttan as a Kathakali artist. [U] / [CO4]

17. Explain why the film’s failure to depict social resistance in Priyanka’s domestic life is considered a regressive choice. [An] / [CO4]

18. Attempt a brief theoretical reading of *Amen* as a text that blends magical realism with local folklore traditions. [A] / [CO4]

19. Describe the main plot of *Maheshinte Prathikaram* in your own words. [U] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

20. ‘*Swaroopam* is about a villager whose life was turned upside down due to his sudden fixation with an imagined past.’ Critically evaluate this statement. [E] / [CO1]

21. What does Ganga’s transformation suggest about memory, identity, and the psychological burden of inherited stories? [An] / [CO2]

22. Critically evaluate *Perariyathavar* as both an ecological film and a political statement on caste. [E] / [CO3]

23. *Drishyam* is a visualisation of the conflict between the state and the public. Comment. [An] / [CO4]

[15x2 = 30]